Ethan Zaruba-Walker

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EXPERIENCE

StaffRoom AI Emeryville, CA
Founder & AI Solutions Consultant October 2023 - Present

- Own every engagement: source the work, write the statement of work, build it, and stay through handover. Client delivery has run up to $18K on a single engagement.
- Translate a customer's operating problem into the written specification the build is held to: workflows, success criteria, and milestone acceptance, then implement that spec in Python.
- Surface the real constraint during onboarding. Automated an IT MSP's pre-sales risk assessments and trained the team to extend the workflow. Processing time fell 98%.
- Designed a content-scoring evaluation from client ground truth. Human-reviewer agreement reached 95%.
- Ship agent workflows in production with Python, TypeScript, JSON APIs, Git, and MCP. Claude Code drives the LLM work.
- Modernized a data-ingestion pipeline. Throughput increased 99.8% in four months and cost fell 86%.
- Designed a Notion content system and its operating workflow, then trained the producers. Agency volume increased 10x.
- Feed what customers hit in onboarding back as the next build: a living backlog and measured results.
- Delivered EZ-AI, problem-first fluency training so operators can judge and extend the system after handover.
- Ingested federal case documents for an anti-trafficking nonprofit and powered its client-facing analytics dashboard.

IBM Austin, TX
Data Engineer / Cognitive Software Engineer, Customer Support August 2018 - December 2020

- Led Design Thinking sessions, turned stakeholder needs into a build, and wrote release notes for each change.
- Built DRE Bot, a Watson NLP Slack app for support engineers. Common issues fell from a multi-touch case to one response on the tickets that kept coming back.
- Designed IBMLogAnalyze, a GDPR-compliant pipeline and dashboard. Log-analysis prep fell from 1-3 hours to zero, and Tableau and Cognos dashboards went to C-level operators.

Valhalla Healthcare Remote
Machine Learning Engineer (Intern) May 2021 - August 2021

- Built a Python model translating handwritten clinical notes into a structured data model (F1 80.03).

EDUCATION

University of Colorado Boulder Boulder, CO
B.S. Information Science, Major GPA 3.7; Certificate of Cognitive Science August 2018 - May 2023

IBM Online
Systems & Solutions Architecture Professional Certificate Completed 2026

- Business process modeling, requirements and systems analysis, cloud-native delivery, DevOps, and Agile.

DeepLearning.AI Online
Deep Learning Specialization; TensorFlow Developer Professional Certificate 2020 - 2021

SKILLS

Client delivery: statements of work, workflows, success criteria, onboarding discovery, end-to-end testing against a human check, multi-project delivery. Based in Emeryville.

Build: Python (primary), JavaScript/TypeScript, SQL/PostgreSQL, Git, JSON APIs, MCP, Claude Code, n8n, production LLM and agent workflows.

With the team: customer stakeholders on each engagement. Founder ownership brought to a collaborative seat running several projects at once.

Field tools: Docker, GitHub Actions, Slack API, Figma process diagrams, Tableau, Cognos, Vercel.

Handoff: operator training after go-live, measured baselines, human-agreement checks, and a backlog the customer team keeps running after the engagement.

Languages: English, Spanish (conversational).